POLITICAL OBLIGATION, RESISTANCE AND LAW

POLITICAL OBLIGATION: PROBLEM, DEFINITIONS → LAW: NATURE, SCHOOLS AND → OBLIGATION THINKERS FROM HOBBES → JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE → PUNISHMENT, TRAPS, BOUNDARIES AND → THESES AND DIRECTIVE-SPECIFIC ARCHITECTURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — POLITICAL OBLIGATION: PROBLEM, DEFINITIONS AND GROUNDS

POLITICAL OBLIGATION | PROBLEM, DEFINITIONS AND GROUNDS | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] POLITICAL OBLIGATION ASKS WHY, WHEN AND HOW FAR | [2] FORCE EXPLAINS COMPLIANCE BUT CANNOT BY ITSELF CREATE | [3] CONSENT, COMMON GOOD AND RIGHTS SUPPLY RIVAL GROUNDS | [4] THE SUBJECT THEREFORE BEGINS BY SEPARATING POWER, AUTHORITY | COERCIVE SUCCESS EXPLAINS OBEDIENCE BUT NOT A DUTY TO

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Political Obligation: Problem, Definitions and Grounds
- [1] Political obligation asks why, when and how far authority should be obeyed.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Force explains compliance but cannot by itself create a moral duty.
- [3] Consent, common good and rights supply rival grounds of obligation.
- [4] The subject therefore begins by separating power, authority and justified obedience.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Coercive success explains obedience but not a duty to obey.
- ANSWER USE → Open by separating causal compliance from justified obligation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Coercive success explains obedience but not a duty to obey.

01

STAGE 01 — LAW: NATURE, SCHOOLS AND THE RULE-OF-LAW SEQUENCE

NATURE, SCHOOLS AND THE RULE-OF-LAW SEQUENCE | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] PRESCRIPTIVE LAW DIRECTS CONDUCT; SCIENTIFIC LAW DESCRIBES REGULARITY. | [2] NATURAL, ANALYTICAL, HISTORICAL AND SOCIOLOGICAL SCHOOLS ASK DIFFERENT | [3] LEGAL VALIDITY AND MORAL LEGITIMACY CAN DIVERGE WITHOUT | [4] RULE OF LAW JOINS KNOWN RULES TO RESTRAINTS | LAW MUST BE ANALYSED THROUGH VALIDITY, PURPOSE, HISTORY AND | ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS → Law: Nature, Schools and the Rule-of-Law Sequence → [1] Prescriptive law directs conduct; scientific law describes regularity. → [2] Natural, analytical, historical and sociological schools ask different questions. → [3] Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge without making law irrelevant.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Law: Nature, Schools and the Rule-of-Law Sequence
- [1] Prescriptive law directs conduct; scientific law describes regularity.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Natural, analytical, historical and sociological schools ask different questions.
- [3] Legal validity and moral legitimacy can diverge without making law irrelevant.
- [4] Rule of law joins known rules to restraints on arbitrary public power.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Law must be analysed through validity, purpose, history and restraint.
- ANSWER USE → Name the jurisprudential question before selecting a school.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Law must be analysed through validity, purpose, history and restraint.

02

STAGE 02 — OBLIGATION THINKERS FROM HOBBES TO GANDHI

OBLIGATION THINKERS FROM HOBBES TO GANDHI | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] HOBBES PRIORITISES SECURITY; LOCKE TREATS GOVERNMENT AS A | [2] ROUSSEAU LINKS OBEDIENCE TO THE GENERAL WILL; GREEN | [3] MARXISTS AND ANARCHISTS DENY DUTY TO THE COERCIVE | [4] GANDHI AND THOREAU TURN CONSCIENCE INTO DISCIPLINED, PUBLIC | GROUNDS OF OBLIGATION PRODUCE DIFFERENT LIMITS ON RESISTANCE. | ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS

Obligation Thinkers from Hobbes to Gandhi → [1] Hobbes prioritises security; Locke treats government as a limited trust. → [2] Rousseau links obedience to the general will; Green limits it by common good.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Obligation Thinkers from Hobbes to Gandhi
- [1] Hobbes prioritises security; Locke treats government as a limited trust.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Rousseau links obedience to the general will; Green limits it by common good.
- [3] Marxists and anarchists deny duty to the coercive state in different ways.
- [4] Gandhi and Thoreau turn conscience into disciplined, public non-compliance.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Grounds of obligation produce different limits on resistance.
- ANSWER USE → Compare security, trust, civic authorship and common good.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Grounds of obligation produce different limits on resistance.

03

STAGE 03 — JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE APPLICATION

JURISPRUDENCE, RESISTANCE AND COMPARATIVE APPLICATION | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] AUSTIN DEFINES LAW THROUGH SOVEREIGN COMMAND AND SANCTION | [2] KELSEN AND HART RECONSTRUCT POSITIVISM THROUGH NORM HIERARCHY | [3] DWORKIN IS AN INTERPRETIVIST CRITIC, NOT A FOURTH | [4] RESISTANCE, REVOLUTION, OBJECTION AND CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE REMAIN DISTINCT | DWORKIN CHALLENGES POSITIVISM RATHER THAN COMPLETING ITS INTERNAL SEQUENCE. | ANSWER USE

MODEL / STANDARD	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	INSTITUTIONAL LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[2] Kelsen and Hart reconstruct positivism through norm hierarchy and rule structure.	VERDICT → Dworkin challenges positivism rather than completing its internal sequence.
Jurisprudence, Resistance and Comparative Application	[3] Dworkin is an interpretivist critic, not a fourth positivist refinement.	ANSWER USE → Separate Austin, Kelsen, Hart and Dworkin by argumentative role.
[1] Austin defines law through sovereign command and sanction.	[4] Resistance, revolution, objection and civil disobedience remain distinct modes.	

MODEL / STANDARD

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Jurisprudence, Resistance and Comparative Application
- [1] Austin defines law through sovereign command and sanction.

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- [2] Kelsen and Hart reconstruct positivism through norm hierarchy and rule structure.
- [3] Dworkin is an interpretivist critic, not a fourth positivist refinement.
- [4] Resistance, revolution, objection and civil disobedience remain distinct modes.

INSTITUTIONAL LIMIT

- VERDICT → Dworkin challenges positivism rather than completing its internal sequence.
- ANSWER USE → Separate Austin, Kelsen, Hart and Dworkin by argumentative role.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Dworkin challenges positivism rather than completing its internal sequence.

04

STAGE 04 — PUNISHMENT, TRAPS, BOUNDARIES AND SOURCE DISCIPLINE

PUNISHMENT, TRAPS, BOUNDARIES AND SOURCE DISCIPLINE | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] RETRIBUTION ASKS WHAT CULPABLE WRONGDOING DESERVES. | [2] DETERRENCE ASKS WHAT PREVENTS FUTURE CRIME; REFORM ASKS | [3] PROPORTIONALITY LIMITS SEVERITY AND PREVENTS PUNISHMENT FROM BECOMING | [4] LEGAL GUILT NEVER SETTLES AIM, QUANTUM, FALLIBILITY OR. | PUNISHMENT REQUIRES GUILT, A JUSTIFIED AIM AND PROPORTIONATE SEVERITY. | ANSWER USE

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Punishment, Traps, Boundaries and Source Discipline
- [1] Retribution asks what culpable wrongdoing deserves.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Deterrence asks what prevents future crime; reform asks how return is possible.
- [3] Proportionality limits severity and prevents punishment from becoming revenge.
- [4] Legal guilt never settles aim, quantum, fallibility or dignity by itself.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Punishment requires guilt, a justified aim and proportionate severity.
- ANSWER USE → Do not infer deterrence or desert merely from a harsh sentence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Punishment requires guilt, a justified aim and proportionate severity.

05

STAGE 05 — THESES AND DIRECTIVE-SPECIFIC ARCHITECTURE

THESES AND DIRECTIVE-SPECIFIC ARCHITECTURE | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] A POLITICAL-OBLIGATION THESIS MUST IDENTIFY UNLIMITED, LIMITED OR | [2] DIRECTIVE CONTROL DETERMINES WHETHER THE ANSWER DISTINGUISHES, DISCUSSES | [3] CIVIL-DISOBEDIENCE ANSWERS MUST STATE PUBLICITY, NON-VIOLENCE AND ACCEPTED | [4] A JURISPRUDENCE ANSWER MUST SEPARATE POSITIVIST RECONSTRUCTION FROM | DIRECTIVE FIDELITY DETERMINES THE COMPARISON AND VERDICT REQUIRED. | ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS → Theses and Directive-Specific Architecture → [1] A political-obligation thesis must identify unlimited, limited or anti-obligation. → [2] Directive control determines whether the answer distinguishes, discusses or evaluates. → [3] Civil-disobedience answers must state publicity, non-violence and accepted penalty.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Theses and Directive-Specific Architecture
- [1] A political-obligation thesis must identify unlimited, limited or anti-obligation.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Directive control determines whether the answer distinguishes, discusses or evaluates.
- [3] Civil-disobedience answers must state publicity, non-violence and accepted penalty.
- [4] A jurisprudence answer must separate positivist reconstruction from Dworkin's critique.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Directive fidelity determines the comparison and verdict required.
- ANSWER USE → State the obligation camp or jurisprudential dispute in the thesis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Directive fidelity determines the comparison and verdict required.

06

STAGE 06 — AUSTIN, HART AND DWORKIN: ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION

AUSTIN, HART AND DWORKIN | ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] AUSTIN'S COMMAND MODEL CANNOT EXPLAIN EVERY POWER-CONFERRING LEGAL | [2] HART ANSWERS WITH PRIMARY AND SECONDARY RULES GROUNDED | [3] DWORKIN ARGUES THAT LEGAL PRINCIPLES CONSTRAIN HARD CASES | [4] THE RESIDUAL DISPUTE CONCERNS SOURCES, PRINCIPLES AND JUDICIAL | LEGAL SYSTEMS CONTAIN COMMANDS, RULES, PRACTICES AND CONTESTED PRINCIPLES.

CENTRAL FOCUS

Austin, Hart and Dworkin: Argument Reconstruction → [1] Austin's command model cannot explain every power-conferring legal rule. → [2] Hart answers with primary and secondary rules grounded in social practice.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Austin, Hart and Dworkin: Argument Reconstruction
- [1] Austin's command model cannot explain every power-conferring legal rule.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Hart answers with primary and secondary rules grounded in social practice.
- [3] Dworkin argues that legal principles constrain hard cases beyond pedigree tests.
- [4] The residual dispute concerns sources, principles and judicial interpretation.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Legal systems contain commands, rules, practices and contested principles.
- ANSWER USE → Reconstruct each critique before judging the remaining dispute.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Legal systems contain commands, rules, practices and contested principles.

07

STAGE 07 — NAMED EVIDENCE FOR OBLIGATION, LAW AND RESISTANCE

NAMED EVIDENCE FOR OBLIGATION, LAW AND RESISTANCE | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] THOREAU'S TAX REFUSAL ILLUSTRATES CONSCIENCE AGAINST PARTICIPATION IN | [2] GANDHI'S SALT-LAW DEFIANCE ILLUSTRATES PUBLIC AND NON-VIOLENT CIVIL | [3] KELSEN'S GRUNDNORM AND DWORKIN'S INHERITANCE PRINCIPLE ARE JURISPRUDENTIAL | [4] TRAFFIC REGULATION ILLUSTRATES CLARITY AND RELEVANT DIFFERENTIATION UNDER | NAMED EXAMPLES EARN MARKS ONLY WHEN THEIR CONCEPTUAL ROLE | ANSWER USE

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Named Evidence for Obligation, Law and Resistance
- [1] Thoreau's tax refusal illustrates conscience against participation in injustice.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Gandhi's salt-law defiance illustrates public and non-violent civil disobedience.
- [3] Kelsen's Grundnorm and Dworkin's inheritance principle are jurisprudential evidence.
- [4] Traffic regulation illustrates clarity and relevant differentiation under rule of law.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Named examples earn marks only when their conceptual role is explicit.
- ANSWER USE → Pair every event or text with one distinction and one boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Named examples earn marks only when their conceptual role is explicit.

08

STAGE 08 — CLAIM-EVIDENCE-LIMIT AND MARK-SCALED ANSWERS

CLAIM-EVIDENCE-LIMIT AND MARK-SCALED ANSWERS | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] A 10-MARKER NEEDS ONE DISTINCTION, ONE THINKER AND | [2] A 15-MARKER COMPARES GROUNDS OR RUNS ONE OBJECTION | [3] A 20-MARKER INTEGRATES VALIDITY, LEGITIMACY, RESISTANCE AND RULE | [4] EVERY CONCLUSION MUST SPECIFY THE CONDITIONS UNDER WHICH | MARK-SCALED STRUCTURE PREVENTS BOTH SLOGAN AND UNCONTROLLED NARRATION. | ANSWER USE

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Claim-Evidence-Limit and Mark-Scaled Answers
- [1] A 10-marker needs one distinction, one thinker and a direct verdict.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] A 15-marker compares grounds or runs one objection and reply.
- [3] A 20-marker integrates validity, legitimacy, resistance and rule of law.
- [4] Every conclusion must specify the conditions under which obedience remains justified.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Mark-scaled structure prevents both slogan and uncontrolled narration.
- ANSWER USE → Expand from one distinction to an objection-reply architecture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Mark-scaled structure prevents both slogan and uncontrolled narration.

09

STAGE 09 — CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION AND FINAL INTEGRATION

CAUTIOUS INDIAN APPLICATION AND FINAL INTEGRATION | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] THE MARCH 2026 TELE-LAW CONSULTATION IS AN ACCESS-TO-JUSTICE | [2] ACCESSIBLE LEGAL ADVICE CAN MAKE REMEDIES AND COMPLIANCE | [3] SERVICE EXPANSION CANNOT PROVE THAT EVERY ENACTED RULE | [4] USE THE EXAMPLE FOR LEGITIMACY AND RULE-OF-LAW ACCESS | ACCESS TO LEGAL ADVICE CAN SUPPORT LEGITIMACY WITHOUT PROVING | ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS → Cautious Indian Application and Final Integration → [1] The March 2026 Tele-Law consultation is an access-to-justice anchor. → [2] Accessible legal advice can make remedies and compliance practically meaningful. → [3] Service expansion cannot prove that every enacted rule or official act is just.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- Cautious Indian Application and Final Integration
- [1] The March 2026 Tele-Law consultation is an access-to-justice anchor.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Accessible legal advice can make remedies and compliance practically meaningful.
- [3] Service expansion cannot prove that every enacted rule or official act is just.
- [4] Use the example for legitimacy and rule-of-law access, not unverified legal detail.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Access to legal advice can support legitimacy without proving justice.
- ANSWER USE → Use Tele-Law only for remedies, accessibility and rule-of-law capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER USE → Use Tele-Law only for remedies, accessibility and rule-of-law capacity.

10

STAGE 10 — MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR

MCQ REMEDIATION AND TRAP REPAIR | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] CLOSE OPTIONS TEST FORCE VERSUS DUTY AND VALIDITY | [2] THEY ALSO TEST RESISTANCE VERSUS REVOLUTION AND OBJECTION | [3] AUSTIN, KELSEN AND HART REMAIN DISTINCT FROM DWORKIN'S | [4] PUNISHMENT THEORIES ANSWER DESERT, PREVENTION AND REFORM QUESTIONS | CLOSE OPTIONS ARE SEPARATED BY TARGET, METHOD AND JUSTIFICATORY | ANSWER USE

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair → [1] Close options test force versus duty and validity versus legitimacy. → [2] They also test resistance versus revolution and objection versus civil disobedience.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair
- [1] Close options test force versus duty and validity versus legitimacy.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] They also test resistance versus revolution and objection versus civil disobedience.
- [3] Austin, Kelsen and Hart remain distinct from Dworkin's interpretivist challenge.
- [4] Punishment theories answer desert, prevention and reform questions separately.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Close options are separated by target, method and justificatory basis.
- ANSWER USE → Identify the decisive distinction before eliminating an option.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Close options are separated by target, method and justificatory basis.

11

STAGE 11 — PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE

PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER PRACTICE | CENTRAL FOCUS | [1] FOUR PUNISHMENT PYQS ARE TRANSFERRED ONLY FOR CROSS-APPLICATION. | [2] PRIMARY OWNERSHIP REMAINS PHILOSOPHY PAPER II - CRIME | [3] SIX ORIGINAL QUESTIONS TEST OBLIGATION, RESISTANCE, JURISPRUDENCE AND | [4] FINAL RECALL | VALID LAW EARNS DUTY ONLY THROUGH LEGITIMACY AND NON-ARBITRARY | CROSS-APPLIED PYQS RETAIN THEIR CRIME AND PUNISHMENT OWNERSHIP.

CENTRAL FOCUS → PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice → [1] Four punishment PYQs are transferred only for cross-application. → [2] Primary ownership remains Philosophy Paper II - Crime and Punishment. → [3] Six original questions test obligation, resistance, jurisprudence and rule of law.

CONCEPT / THINKER

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice
- [1] Four punishment PYQs are transferred only for cross-application.

POLITICAL MECHANISM

- [2] Primary ownership remains Philosophy Paper II - Crime and Punishment.
- [3] Six original questions test obligation, resistance, jurisprudence and rule of law.
- [4] Final recall: valid law earns duty only through legitimacy and non-arbitrary rule.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → Cross-applied PYQs retain their Crime and Punishment ownership.
- ANSWER USE → Cite ownership, then apply only the relevant Political Theory lens.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Cross-applied PYQs retain their Crime and Punishment ownership.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | 1. ONE-SCREEN ADVANCED MAP | 2. SCOPE, ASSUMPTIONS AND CONCEPTUAL BOUNDARY | 3. DIRECT-BOOK ARGUMENT RECONSTRUCTION | 4. DEFINITIONS AND DISTINCTIONS | 5. THINKER-BY-THINKER POSITIONS | 6. COMPETING PERSPECTIVES | 7. INTERNAL DEBATES AND CRITICISMS

OPTIONAL THEORY DEPTH

- 1. One-screen advanced map
- 2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary
- 3. Direct-book argument reconstruction
- 4. Definitions and distinctions

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- 5. Thinker-by-thinker positions
- 6. Competing perspectives
- 7. Internal debates and criticisms
- 8. Comparative matrix

COMPARATIVE / INSTITUTIONAL NUANCE

- 9. Application without current-affairs dependence
- 10. UPSC answer-engine prompts
- 11. Cross-links and exclusions
- 12. Factual-risk checks

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels